GLOBALISATION, TRADE AGREEMENTS AND EXTERNAL-POLICY EFFECTS

CENTRAL QUESTION AND THE → THREE TRANSMISSION CHANNELS INTO → HOW THE TRADE ORGANISATION → MINISTERIAL CYCLE AND THE → THE APPELLATE VOID AND → ONE AGREEMENT, THREE LEGAL

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ● APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g1 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00

CENTRAL QUESTION AND THE CO-PRESENCE ANSWER

CENTRAL QUESTION AND THE CO-PRESENCE ANSWER · HAS GLOBALISATION ENDED OR IS IT BEING CONTESTED? · WANING, NOT ENDED; INTEGRATION AND CONTROL OPERATE TOGETHER · TRADE, CAPITAL, TECHNOLOGY AND INFORMATION INTEGRATION · SOVEREIGN NATIONALISM · NATIONAL CONTROL OVER TRADE, TECHNOLOGY, BORDERS AND STRATEGIC INDUSTRIES · PROTECTIONISM, EXPORT CONTROLS, BUY-NATIONAL POLICY · CO-PRESENT FORCES OF DIFFERING STRENGTH ACROSS SECTORS AND STATES

INTEREST / DOCTRINE

- CENTRAL QUESTION — has globalisation ended or is it being contested?
- ANSWER — waning, not ended; integration and control operate together
- GLOBALISATION — trade, capital, technology and information integration

DIPLOMATIC MECHANISM

- SOVEREIGN NATIONALISM — national control over trade, technology, borders and strategic industries; protectionism, export controls, buy-national policy
- RELATION — co-present forces of differing strength across sectors and states
- PYQ WORDING — the 2025 demand itself says waning, never ended

CONSTRAINT / TRADE-OFF

- BOUNDARY — tariff and balance-of-payments mechanics to Economy
- de-risking detail to topic 03; the organisation's full structure to topic 12

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: de-risking detail to topic 03; the organisation's full structure to topic 12.

01

STAGE 01

THREE TRANSMISSION CHANNELS INTO INDIAN INTERESTS

THREE TRANSMISSION CHANNELS INTO INDIAN INTERESTS · TRADE CHANNEL · STALLED MULTILATERAL LIBERALISATION MIGRATION OF LIBERALISATION INTO BILATERAL AND · TECHNOLOGY CHANNEL · EXPORT CONTROLS · INVESTMENT SCREENING · CLIMATE CHANNEL · CARBON-BORDER MEASURES · TRADE CHANNEL — protectionism

stalled multilateral liberalisation migration of liberalisation into bilateral and plurilateral agreements → TECHNOLOGY CHANNEL — export controls → investment screening

INTEREST / DOCTRINE

- TRADE CHANNEL — protectionism
- stalled multilateral liberalisation migration of liberalisation into bilateral and plurilateral agreements
- TECHNOLOGY CHANNEL — export controls
- investment screening

DIPLOMATIC MECHANISM

- CLIMATE CHANNEL — carbon-border measures
- green-subsidy competition
- COMBINED INSTRUMENT — one measure can be trade, industrial policy and climate
- INDIA AS BENEFICIARY — diversification interest, owned in detail by topic 03

CONSTRAINT / TRADE-OFF

- INDIA AS TARGET — others' tariffs and carbon-border measures
- RULE — name the channel before describing the effect

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE — name the channel before describing the effect.

02

STAGE 02

HOW THE TRADE ORGANISATION IS ACTUALLY BUILT

HOW THE TRADE ORGANISATION IS ACTUALLY BUILT · RUN BY MEMBER GOVERNMENTS; NO DELEGATED BOARD OR HEAD · MINISTERIAL CONFERENCE · TOPMOST BODY; MEETS AT LEAST ONCE EVERY TWO YEARS · GENERAL COUNCIL · THE SAME BODY IN THREE GUISES · DISPUTE SETTLEMENT BODY · TRADE POLICY REVIEW BODY · MEMBER-DRIVEN — run by member governments; no delegated board or head

MINISTERIAL CONFERENCE — topmost body; meets at least once every two years → GENERAL COUNCIL — the same body in three guises → General Council

INTEREST / DOCTRINE

- MEMBER-DRIVEN — run by member governments; no delegated board or head
- MINISTERIAL CONFERENCE — topmost body; meets at least once every two years
- GENERAL COUNCIL — the same body in three guises
- General Council

DIPLOMATIC MECHANISM

- Dispute Settlement Body
- Trade Policy Review Body
- SECTOR COUNCILS — Goods
- Trade-Related Intellectual Property

CONSTRAINT / TRADE-OFF

- DECISION RULE — normally by consensus among the whole membership
- ENFORCEMENT — by members themselves; sanctions authorised by the membership
- FOUNDED 1995 — India a founding member
- VERDICT — weakened in negotiation; not irrelevant in rules and disputes

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT — weakened in negotiation, not irrelevant in rules and disputes.

03

STAGE 03

MINISTERIAL CYCLE AND THE CONSENSUS CHOKEPOINT

MINISTERIAL CYCLE AND THE CONSENSUS CHOKEPOINT · 26 FEBRUARY – 2 MARCH 2024 · MC13, ABU DHABI; ABU DHABI MINISTERIAL · DECLARATION: DECISIONS ON DISPUTE-SETTLEMENT REFORM, SPECIAL AND DIFFERENTIAL TREATMENT · 26 MARCH 2026 · MC14 OPENS AT YAOUNDE; FOUNDATIONAL-ISSUES BREAKOUT · 27 MARCH 2026 · MINISTER-FACILITATED REFORM BREAKOUTS AND REFORM PLENARY · THIRD DAY — dispute-settlement reform update; ministerial sessions on fisheries subsidies, Investment Facilitation for Development

26 FEBRUARY – 2 MARCH 2024 — MC13, Abu Dhabi; Abu Dhabi Ministerial → Declaration; decisions on dispute-settlement reform, special and differential treatment, LDC graduation and electronic commerce → 26 MARCH 2026 — MC14 opens at Yaounde; foundational-issues breakout → 27 MARCH 2026 — minister-facilitated reform breakouts and reform plenary → THIRD DAY — dispute-settlement reform update; ministerial sessions on fisheries subsidies, Investment Facilitation for Development

INTEREST / DOCTRINE

- 26 FEBRUARY – 2 MARCH 2024 — MC13, Abu Dhabi; Abu Dhabi Ministerial
- Declaration; decisions on dispute-settlement reform, special and differential treatment, LDC graduation and electronic commerce
- 26 MARCH 2026 — MC14 opens at Yaounde; foundational-issues breakout

DIPLOMATIC MECHANISM

- 27 MARCH 2026 — minister-facilitated reform breakouts and reform plenary
- THIRD DAY — dispute-settlement reform update; ministerial sessions on fisheries subsidies, Investment Facilitation for Development incorporation.
- E-commerce Work Programme and moratorium, agriculture, development and LDCs

CONSTRAINT / TRADE-OFF

- 30 MARCH 2026 — Heads of Delegation meeting and closing session
- CHOKEPOINT — 165 of 166 supported incorporation; consensus absent; it failed
- LESSON — the veto point is procedural, never majoritarian

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LESSON — the veto point is procedural, never majoritarian.

04

STAGE 04

THE APPELLATE VOID AND INDIA'S OWN NOTIFIED APPEALS

THE APPELLATE VOID AND INDIA'S OWN NOTIFIED APPEALS · 10 DECEMBER 2019 · APPELLATE BODY LOSES ITS QUORUM FOR NEW APPEALS · 30 NOVEMBER 2026 · ZERO MEMBERS; APPEALS CAN BE FILED INTO THE VOID · INTERIM APPEAL ARBITRATION UNDER DSU ARTICLE 25; INDIA NOT · CURRENT NOTIFIED APPEALS INVOLVING INDIA, AS LISTED BY THE · 24 DECEMBER 2021

ACTOR / INTEREST	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	STATUS TRAP / LIMIT
10 DECEMBER 2019 — Appellate Body loses its quorum for new appeals	24 December 2021 — DS579 sugar and sugarcane (Brazil)	8 December 2023 — DS582 tariff treatment, ICT sector
30 NOVEMBER 2020 — zero members; appeals can be filed into the void	24 December 2021 — DS580 sugar and sugarcane (Australia)	COST — two-sided: no binding appellate review for India either
MPIA — interim appeal arbitration under DSU Article 25; India not a participant	24 December 2021 — DS581 sugar and sugarcane (Guatemala)	
CURRENT NOTIFIED APPEALS INVOLVING INDIA, AS LISTED BY THE ORGANISATION	17 May 2023 — DS584 tariff treatment on certain goods (Japan)	

ACTOR / INTEREST

- 10 DECEMBER 2019 — Appellate Body loses its quorum for new appeals
- 30 NOVEMBER 2020 — zero members; appeals can be filed into the void
- MPIA — interim appeal arbitration under DSU Article 25; India not a participant
- CURRENT NOTIFIED APPEALS INVOLVING INDIA, AS LISTED BY THE ORGANISATION

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- 24 December 2021 — DS579 sugar and sugarcane (Brazil)
- 24 December 2021 — DS580 sugar and sugarcane (Australia)
- 24 December 2021 — DS581 sugar and sugarcane (Guatemala)
- 17 May 2023 — DS584 tariff treatment on certain goods (Japan)

STATUS TRAP / LIMIT

- 8 December 2023 — DS582 tariff treatment, ICT sector
- COST — two-sided: no binding appellate review for India either

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COST — two-sided: no binding appellate review for India either.

05

STAGE 05

ONE AGREEMENT, THREE LEGAL STEPS, THREE DATES

ONE AGREEMENT, THREE LEGAL STEPS, THREE DATES · STEP 1 ADOPTION · AGREEMENT ON FISHERIES SUBSIDIES ADOPTED AT MC12 · 17 JUNE 2022; PROHIBITS HARMFUL FISHERIES SUBSIDIES FIRST AGREEMENT · FIRST BROAD BINDING MULTILATERAL AGREEMENT ON OCEAN SUSTAINABILITY · ONLY THE SECOND MULTILATERAL AGREEMENT REACHED SINCE ITS INCEPTION · STEP 2 ENTRY INTO FORCE · ON TWO-THIRDS ACCEPTANCE; THRESHOLD REACHED AT A CEREMONY ON

STEP 1 ADOPTION — Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies adopted at MC12 → 17 June 2022; prohibits harmful fisheries subsidies first agreement of the organisation to focus on → first broad binding multilateral agreement on ocean sustainability → only the second multilateral agreement reached since its inception → STEP 2 ENTRY INTO FORCE — on two-thirds acceptance; threshold reached at a ceremony on

DATED OFFICIAL INSTRUMENT

- STEP 1 ADOPTION — Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies adopted at MC12.
- 17 June 2022; prohibits harmful fisheries subsidies first agreement of the organisation to focus on the environment
- first broad binding multilateral agreement on ocean sustainability

EVIDENTIARY LEVEL IT REACHES

- only the second multilateral agreement reached since its inception
- STEP 2 ENTRY INTO FORCE — on two-thirds acceptance; threshold reached at a ceremony on 15 September 2023
- STEP 3 INDIVIDUAL ACCEPTANCE — India deposits its instrument, 20 July 2026

STATUS / CLAIM LIMIT

- MANDATE — MC11 Buenos Aires Ministerial Decision and SDG 14.6
- CONTINUING — additional provisions under the Negotiating Group on Rules

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONTINUING — additional provisions under the Negotiating Group on Rules.

06

STAGE 06

AGRICULTURE AND THE REFORM DEMAND INDIA ACTUALLY MAKES

AGRICULTURE AND THE REFORM DEMAND INDIA ACTUALLY MAKES · PUBLIC-STOCKHOLDING PROCUREMENT COLLIDES WITH DOMESTIC-SUPPORT RULES · THE 2013 BALI PEACE CLAUSE SHIELDS ELIGIBLE PROGRAMMES FROM · THE SHIELD CARRIES NOTIFICATION AND PROGRAMME CONDITIONS · INTERIM PROTECTION IS NOT THE PERMANENT SETTLEMENT INDIA SEEKS · INDIA'S DEMAND · PRESERVE PUBLIC STOCKHOLDING AND SPECIAL AND DIFFERENTIAL TREATMENT WHILE · PRODUCER SUPPORT, CONSUMER FOOD SECURITY AND EXPORT EFFECTS TOGETHER

INTEREST / DOCTRINE

- PROBLEM — public-stockholding procurement collides with domestic-support rules
- RESPONSE: the 2013 Bali peace clause shields eligible programmes from specified legal challenge while a permanent solution is negotiated
- LIMIT — the shield carries notification and programme conditions

DIPLOMATIC MECHANISM

- LIMIT — interim protection is not the permanent settlement India seeks
- INDIA'S DEMAND — preserve public stockholding and special and differential treatment while improving subsidy and market-access rules
- BALANCE — producer support, consumer food security and export effects together

CONSTRAINT / TRADE-OFF

- DIAGNOSIS — reform here is distributive, not merely procedural

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DIAGNOSIS — reform here is distributive, not merely procedural.

07

STAGE 07

THE LEGAL-STAGE LADDER FOR INDIA'S AGREEMENTS

THE LEGAL-STAGE LADDER FOR INDIA'S AGREEMENTS · IN FORCE · INDIA–UAE CEPA, 1 MAY 2022 · INDIA–AUSTRALIA ECTA, 29 DECEMBER 2022 · INDIA–EFTA TEPA, SIGNED 10 MARCH 2024, IN FORCE 1 · INDIA–UK CETA, SIGNED LONDON 24 JULY 2025, IN FORCE · DOUBLE CONTRIBUTIONS CONVENTION IN FORCE THE SAME DAY; UP · INDIA–OMAN CEPA, 18 DECEMBER 2025; INDIA–NEW ZEALAND, 27 APRIL

ACTOR / INTEREST	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	STATUS TRAP / LIMIT
IN FORCE — India–UAE CEPA, 1 May 2022	Double Contributions Convention in force the same day; up to 60 months of home-country social-security coverage for detached workers	NEITHER — India-United States: interim framework and continuing negotiation
IN FORCE — India–Australia ECTA, 29 December 2022	SIGNED — India–Oman CEPA, 18 December 2025; India-New Zealand, 27 April 2026	RULE — concluded, signed, ratified and in force are four different claims
IN FORCE — India EFTA TEPA, signed 10 March 2024, in force 1 October 2025	CONCLUDED — India–Chile CEPA, 5 December 2025	
IN FORCE — India–UK CETA, signed London 24 July 2025, in force 15 July 2026	CONCLUDED ONLY — India–EU FTA, 27 January 2026; not signed, not in force	

ACTOR / INTEREST

- IN FORCE — India–UAE CEPA, 1 May 2022
- IN FORCE — India–Australia ECTA, 29 December 2022
- IN FORCE — India–EFTA TEPA, signed 10 March 2024, in force 1 October 2025
- IN FORCE — India–UK CETA, signed London 24 July 2025, in force 15 July 2026

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- Double Contributions Convention in force the same day; up to 60 months of home-country social-security coverage for detached workers
- SIGNED — India–Oman CEPA, 18 December 2025; India-New Zealand, 27 April 2026
- CONCLUDED — India–Chile CEPA, 5 December 2025
- CONCLUDED ONLY — India–EU FTA, 27 January 2026; not signed, not in force

STATUS TRAP / LIMIT

- NEITHER — India-United States: interim framework and continuing negotiation
- RULE — concluded, signed, ratified and in force are four different claims

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE — concluded, signed, ratified and in force are four different claims.

08

STAGE 08

FOUR VERBS IN ONE COMMUNIQUE

FOUR VERBS IN ONE COMMUNIQUE · 16TH INDIA-EU SUMMIT, 27 JANUARY 2026 · FREE TRADE AGREEMENT NEGOTIATIONS; NOT SIGNED, NOT IN FORCE · SECURITY AND DEFENCE PARTNERSHIP · NEGOTIATIONS ON A SECURITY OF INFORMATION AGREEMENT · TOWARDS 2030 · INDIA-EU JOINT COMPREHENSIVE STRATEGIC AGENDA · OBLIGATION LEVEL

ACTOR / INTEREST	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	STATUS TRAP / LIMIT
16th INDIA-EU SUMMIT, 27 JANUARY 2026	LAUNCHED — negotiations on a Security of Information Agreement	SEPARATE BOUNDARY — India announced on 4 November 2019 that it would not join the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership
CONCLUDED — free trade agreement negotiations; not signed, not in force	ADOPTED — Towards 2030: India-EU Joint Comprehensive Strategic Agenda	RULE — reproduce the verb the source actually used
SIGNED — Security and Defence Partnership	OBLIGATION LEVEL — four verbs, four different obligations, one document	

ACTOR / INTEREST

- 16th INDIA-EU SUMMIT, 27 JANUARY 2026
- CONCLUDED — free trade agreement negotiations; not signed, not in force
- SIGNED — Security and Defence Partnership

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- LAUNCHED — negotiations on a Security of Information Agreement
- ADOPTED — Towards 2030: India-EU Joint Comprehensive Strategic Agenda
- OBLIGATION LEVEL — four verbs, four different obligations, one document

STATUS TRAP / LIMIT

- SEPARATE BOUNDARY — India announced on 4 November 2019 that it would not join the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership
- RULE — reproduce the verb the source actually used

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE — reproduce the verb the source actually used.

09

STAGE 09

THE CARBON-BORDER REGIME IN OPERATION

THE CARBON-BORDER REGIME IN OPERATION · DEFINITIVE REGIME · APPLIES FROM 1 JANUARY 2026 · TRANSITIONAL PHASE · 2023 TO 2025 · IMPORTER AUTHORISATION · PURCHASE AND SURRENDER OF CERTIFICATES MATCHING THE EMBEDDED CARBON · IRON AND STEEL

ACTOR / INTEREST	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	STATUS TRAP / LIMIT
DEFINITIVE REGIME — applies from 1 January 2026	SECTORS — cement	CLASSIFICATION — trade instrument, industrial-policy tool and climate measure
TRANSITIONAL PHASE — 2023 to 2025	iron and steel	INDIA — affected through market access, standards and negotiating strategy without being a party to the European Union's internal law
OBLIGATIONS — importer authorisation	electricity hydrogen	
purchase and surrender of certificates matching the embedded carbon emissions of imported goods	PRICE — calculated from EU Emissions Trading System allowance auction prices	

ACTOR / INTEREST

- DEFINITIVE REGIME — applies from 1 January 2026
- TRANSITIONAL PHASE — 2023 to 2025
- OBLIGATIONS — importer authorisation
- purchase and surrender of certificates matching the embedded carbon emissions of imported goods

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- SECTORS — cement
- iron and steel
- electricity hydrogen
- PRICE — calculated from EU Emissions Trading System allowance auction prices

STATUS TRAP / LIMIT

- CLASSIFICATION — trade instrument, industrial-policy tool and climate measure
- INDIA — affected through market access, standards and negotiating strategy without being a party to the European Union's internal law

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: INDIA — affected through market access, standards and negotiating strategy without being a party to the European Union's internal law.

10

STAGE 10

TARIFF VOLATILITY AS THE TRANSMISSION MECHANISM

TARIFF VOLATILITY AS THE TRANSMISSION MECHANISM · 7 AUGUST 2025 · 25 PER CENT RECIPROCAL DUTY ON INDIA TARIFF EFFECT · 27 AUGUST 2025 · ADDITIONAL 25 PER CENT DUTY LINKED TO RUSSIAN OIL · 7 FEBRUARY 2026 · THE ADDITIONAL RUSSIAN-OIL-LINKED DUTY IS REMOVED · FEBRUARY 2026

7 AUGUST 2025 — 25 per cent reciprocal duty on India takes effect → 27 AUGUST 2025 — additional 25 per cent duty linked to Russian oil → 7 FEBRUARY 2026 — the additional Russian-oil-linked duty is removed → FEBRUARY 2026 — additional duties under the International Emergency → Economic Powers Act end

INTEREST / DOCTRINE

- 7 AUGUST 2025 — 25 per cent reciprocal duty on India takes effect
- 27 AUGUST 2025 — additional 25 per cent duty linked to Russian oil
- 7 FEBRUARY 2026 — the additional Russian-oil-linked duty is removed

DIPLOMATIC MECHANISM

- FEBRUARY 2026 — additional duties under the International Emergency
- Economic Powers Act end
- 24 JULY 2026 — a separate 10 per cent duty under Section 301 begins

CONSTRAINT / TRADE-OFF

- STATUS — another state's domestic measures; exposure, not Indian obligation
- MECHANISM — a duty lasting under six months still shaped a negotiating cycle
- ANSWER LINE — volatility, not level, is what transmits

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ANSWER LINE — volatility, not level, is what transmits.

11

STAGE 11

ANSWER SPINE FOR A GLOBALISATION OR TRADE-EFFECTS DEMAND

ANSWER SPINE FOR A GLOBALISATION OR TRADE-EFFECTS DEMAND · DEFINE BOTH FORCES AND STATE THAT THEY ARE CO-PRESENT · NAME TRADE, TECHNOLOGY OR CLIMATE BEFORE DESCRIBING THE EFFECT · ONE DATED INSTRUMENT PER CHANNEL, EACH AT ITS EXACT · DUAL POSITION · INDIA AS DIVERSIFICATION BENEFICIARY AND AS MEASURE TARGET · CONTINUED ORGANISATION ENGAGEMENT; AGREEMENT NEGOTIATION AND DOMESTIC STRATEGIC-SECTOR POLICY · RULES-OF-ORIGIN FRAGMENTATION, TRANSITION COST, CONTESTED PROPORTIONALITY OF CLIMATE MEASURES

OPEN — define both forces and state that they are co-present, not sequential → CHANNEL — name trade, technology or climate before describing the effect → EVIDENCE — one dated instrument per channel, each at its exact legal stage → DUAL POSITION — India as diversification beneficiary and as measure target → RESPONSE — continued organisation engagement, agreement negotiation and domestic strategic-sector policy, which is Economy's operational

INTEREST / DOCTRINE

- OPEN — define both forces and state that they are co-present, not sequential
- CHANNEL — name trade, technology or climate before describing the effect
- EVIDENCE — one dated instrument per channel, each at its exact legal stage

DIPLOMATIC MECHANISM

- DUAL POSITION — India as diversification beneficiary and as measure target
- RESPONSE — continued organisation engagement, agreement negotiation and domestic strategic-sector policy, which is Economy's operational domain
- CONCEDE — rules-of-origin fragmentation, transition cost, contested proportionality of climate measures, two-sided appellate paralysis

CONSTRAINT / TRADE-OFF

- OWNERSHIP — the 2025 elucidate, 2018 reform and 2022 climate-fora demands
- CLOSE — open enough for markets and technology, resilient enough to absorb volatility, and active enough to shape the rules that transmit it

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE — open enough for markets and technology, resilient enough to absorb volatility, and active enough to shape the rules that transmit it.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · RETAINS ITS DISPUTE-SETTLEMENT AND BASELINE-RULE FUNCTION, BUT · BILATERAL FTA/CEPA ARCHITECTURE · INDIA–EFTA TEPA (SIGNED 10 MARCH 2024) · BEYOND TRADE IN THE SAME SUMMITS · THE 16TH INDIA-EU SUMMIT ALSO SIGNED · MINILATERAL TRADE-TECHNOLOGY FRAMEWORKS · ARRANGEMENTS COMBINING TRADE

OPTIONAL DOCTRINE AND INSTRUMENT DEPTH

- WTO: retains its dispute-settlement and baseline-rule function, but
- Bilateral FTA/CEPA architecture: India–EFTA TEPA (signed 10 March 2024,
- Beyond trade in the same summits: the 16th India-EU Summit also signed
- CAUTION: Minilateral trade-technology frameworks; arrangements combining trade.

STATUS, DATE AND FIGURE LIMIT

- Carbon-border and green-subsidy measures: the EU's Carbon Border
- Unilateral tariff measures as external-policy effects; the 2025–26 US
- Direct PYQ boundary case (2025 Q10): the question's own 'rearing…
- CAUTION: Boundary case — India as both beneficiary and target: India

COMPARATIVE DIPLOMATIC NUANCE

- CAUTION: Boundary case — climate policy as trade policy: carbon-border-type
- CAUTION: Boundary case — FTA proliferation as globalisation, not retreat: the
- CAUTION: FTA proliferation fragments the rules landscape; a growing patchwork
- CAUTION: De-risking has real economic transition costs: reducing

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.